independent directors strongly backed Mistry and supported his continuation as IHCL chairman. The meeting started with Parekh applauding the chair's leadership and ended with Mistry and his brother thanking all the independent directors for their support.

What transpired at the meeting was seen as a concerted effort by Mistry to retain control of the company. It raised hackles in Bombay House. Mistry, however, refuted the allegation that he was attempting to wrest control of the company and dismissed it as a travesty of truth.

Three days later, the board of Tata Teleservices met, but the issue of Mistry continuing as chairman did not come up for discussion. After the unusual parleys held by Mistry's supporters before the IHCL board meeting, Bombay House moved to remove Mistry from the board of Tata companies. On 9 November, Tata Sons which, together with Tata Trusts, held 35.8 per cent stake in IHCL, issued a special notice directing the company to convene an EGM of the shareholders to decide on the removal of Mistry as the director. It also added that Mistry's conduct since his removal had 'caused enormous harm to the Tata group, IHCL and its stakeholders, including employees and shareholders'. It also sent a similar notice to Tata Teleservices.

On the same day, Mistry was removed as chairman of TCS. The holding company, which held a 73.26 per cent stake in the software giant, nominated Ishaat Hussain as the interim chairman with immediate effect. Mistry, however, contested the decision, stating that Tata Sons only had the right to nominate a candidate and not appoint one. Commenting on his removal as chairman of the software giant, Mistry called the move an evidence of the 'cloak and dagger' machinations that defined 'the angry strategy of the Ratan Tata camp'. The same day, Tata Sons also issued a special notice and a requisition to TCS, calling for an EGM to remove Mistry as director in the company.

The next day, Tata Chemicals held its board meeting in a tense and a highly charged atmosphere. The seven-member board consisted of four independent directors. Though it was held to approve the second quarter financial results of the company, it became the platform for Mistry and Nusli Wadia to attempt to wrest control of the company to the exclusion of Tata Sons.

After Mistry was replaced as chairman, Tata Sons, Wadia had called up Mukundan. He said that he was doing so at Mistry's behest and requested